Drama teacher and cover plan

Creative Arts · BUILD · Spring 2 Week 3 · Tuesday 9 March 2027 · P1

Lesson

Make the story clear

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Year A · Explore · Theme Resilience & Change

Weekly outcome

Sequence a short drama with a group.

Today I can

I can show our story in order.

I can use a clear cue or pose.

I can say what we changed.

Prepare

For three or four pupils: books or arts logs and pencils.

A clear personal space for each pupil, or seats with safe room for hand gestures.

Three cue words read from the activity card: Start, Next, End. No real den, sticks, boxes or props.

Bring the previous sequence and logs if available. If missing or the pupil was absent, make a fresh attempt and date it today.

Cover route

Retrieve the three-part den story or rebuild it from today's Starter. Model a rushed version and a calm version with a held middle pose. Let pupils choose one cue or pose to change. Rehearse, share with an agreed small audience and keep actual feedback plus each pupil's own log. No prior attendance, device or prop is required.

Drama teaching sequence

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Arrival 3 minutes

Say: Today we will make The new den clear for a watcher. You can keep your role or change it. A hand pose, cue or directing choice counts. If our record is missing, we will make the three parts again and date them today.

Look for: Pupils retrieve or rebuild a truthful sequence and confirm roles and stop signal.

Fallback: Read the three story beats from today's Starter and offer hand poses or directing.

Check and response: Missing work is not reconstructed as evidence from yesterday. A fresh attempt is recorded with today's date.

Starter 3 minutes

Say: Tell or point to the first, next and last parts. Which part did our watcher find hard to see? If no one watched yet, the adult will watch one calm try now. Choose one part to improve.

Look for: Pupil recalls the order and chooses a specific pose or cue for improvement.

Fallback: Adult shows two possible changes: hold the middle pose longer or use a Next cue. Pupil chooses.

Check and response: The useful target is a clear change or cue, not louder speech or bigger movement.

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I do 6 minutes

Say: I rush from the big space to the small den. Now I hold close hands for three counts and wait for Next. The story has the same three parts. I changed the time I held the middle pose. Which try let you see the change?

Look for: Adult isolates one change and models before and after. Pupil links hold time or cue clarity to story understanding.

Fallback: Use only hands at the desk. Count quietly or show three fingers without speaking.

Check and response: A longer middle pose gives the watcher time to see the small space. A clear silent cue may be as useful as speech.

We do 6 minutes

Say: Choose one target as a group: cue or pose. We will try both versions calmly. Watcher, name a feature you saw. Maker, say whether it fits your idea. No one needs to act out a real worry.

Look for: Group uses a cue and compares versions. Each pupil confirms a role or a creative decision.

Fallback: Adult calls cues while one pupil chooses how long to hold the middle pose. Let another pupil watch privately.

Check and response: Example feedback: I could see the small space when the pose stayed still. A valid alternative: the silent cue helped us move together.

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Create 14 minutes

Say: Use four minutes to rehearse and three to test the one agreed change. Use three minutes to share with your chosen watcher, then four to log your own contribution and feedback. A pupil may direct an adult, narrate, move or give a silent cue. Do not stretch arms into another person's space.

Look for: Ordered story is shared or privately demonstrated. Log captures individual contribution, before-and-after change and actual feedback.

Fallback: Use the original three hand poses and adult cues. Pupil changes one pose hold or points to the cue the adult should use.

Check and response: Example only: Before we rushed the change. Now we hold close hands for three counts. My job was the Next cue. The watcher said the change was clear.

Review 5 minutes

Say: Ask one watcher to describe the start and end. Each maker names or points to their own contribution. A quiet private share is enough. Spend the last two minutes settling, storing work and clearing the space.

Look for: Watcher identifies order. Pupil describes or confirms a real change without claiming all group choices.

Fallback: Adult reads a short observation back to the pupil to confirm or correct.

Check and response: Useful record: The pupil gave the Next cue after the change pose and chose to hold that pose longer. Record adult prompts separately.

Drama evidence and teaching checks

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Exit 3 minutes

Say: Make a short honest record. If the story is still a rehearsal, say so. You can draw, point, speak or ask me to write your words. We will keep the work for the award.

Look for: Dated pupil reflection links one changed feature to story clarity, with actual support recorded.

Fallback: Offer cue or pose as a choice, then record the pupil's confirmed reason or gesture.

Check: Example only: We changed a fast pose to a slow still pose. It helped the watcher see the small space. My next step is to wait for the cue.

Evidence and review

Retain a dated sequence sketch or cue record, a brief adult observation of the real performance or rehearsal, and each pupil's own confirmed arts-log words. Record the contribution, change and support actually used. A photograph or recording is optional under local consent procedures. Never enter a teacher model as pupil work.

Misconceptions

Improving a scene means making it louder - A clearer cue, pause or held pose can improve the story.

We must change the whole story - Change one feature so the audience can follow the same order.

A group record is enough for everyone - Each pupil confirms their own part and help used.

Questions

foundation: Which part comes first?

middle: Which cue helps the next part start?

higher: How does the last pose show the new plan has worked?

Drama access and safety

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Safety

Check a clear personal space before any movement. Walk only; no running, lifting, falling, climbing, throwing or actual building. Keep all imagined props imaginary. Use an agreed open-hand stop cue. Do not move another pupil or their chair.

Emotional and sensory access

Use invented situations. No personal accounts, surprise noise, touch, contact, shouting or forced eye contact. Offer seated movement, silent gesture, narrator or director roles. Pupils may share with a trusted adult only. Agree a calm place and a return cue before starting.

Planned adaptations

Cognition And Learning: Show one story beat at a time. Rehearse three or four beats with concrete cue words. Model the first pose, then fade the adult lead. Check the pupil can point to the next beat.

Communication And Interaction: Offer pointing, signing, a narrator line, directing or an adult scribe. Give processing time. Use I chose ... because ... and First ... next ... last ... .

Semh: Keep the event fictional and low stakes. Agree roles with pupils. Allow a pause, role change or private audience. Praise a specific contribution rather than confidence or compliance.

Sensory And Physical: Perform from a chair, use hands only or direct an adult. Avoid unexpected sound and touch. Ensure personal space. A silent cue is valid.

Eal: Plan in any language. Pair story cues with gestures. Accept oral rehearsal or a labelled sketch. Check the intended story order rather than accent or spelling.

The award and evidence

Both pathways work at Explore. Each lesson is complete without the optional GROW next level stretch. Keep records for the award; these lessons alone do not complete or certify it.

Resilience can include pausing, asking for help, changing a plan and trying a manageable next step. It does not mean hiding feelings, tolerating harm or continuing through pain.